

CITA01 – FOUNDATIONS OF CITY STUDIES SUMMER 2026

JUNE 8TH, 2026

COURSE INSTRUCTOR: OLIVIA BERNARD





LA School

Objectives

Discussion

Chicago
School

SECTOR MODEL
CONCENTRIC RING MODEL
MULTIPLE NUCLEI MODEL

ASSIGNMENT 1

- Due June 15th
- Worth 10 marks




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mirror object to mirror_
mirror_mod.mirror_object

operation == "MIRROR_X":
    mirror_mod.use_x = True
    mirror_mod.use_y = False
    mirror_mod.use_z = False
operation == "MIRROR_Y":
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operation == "MIRROR_Z":
    mirror_mod.use_x = False
    mirror_mod.use_y = False
    mirror_mod.use_z = True
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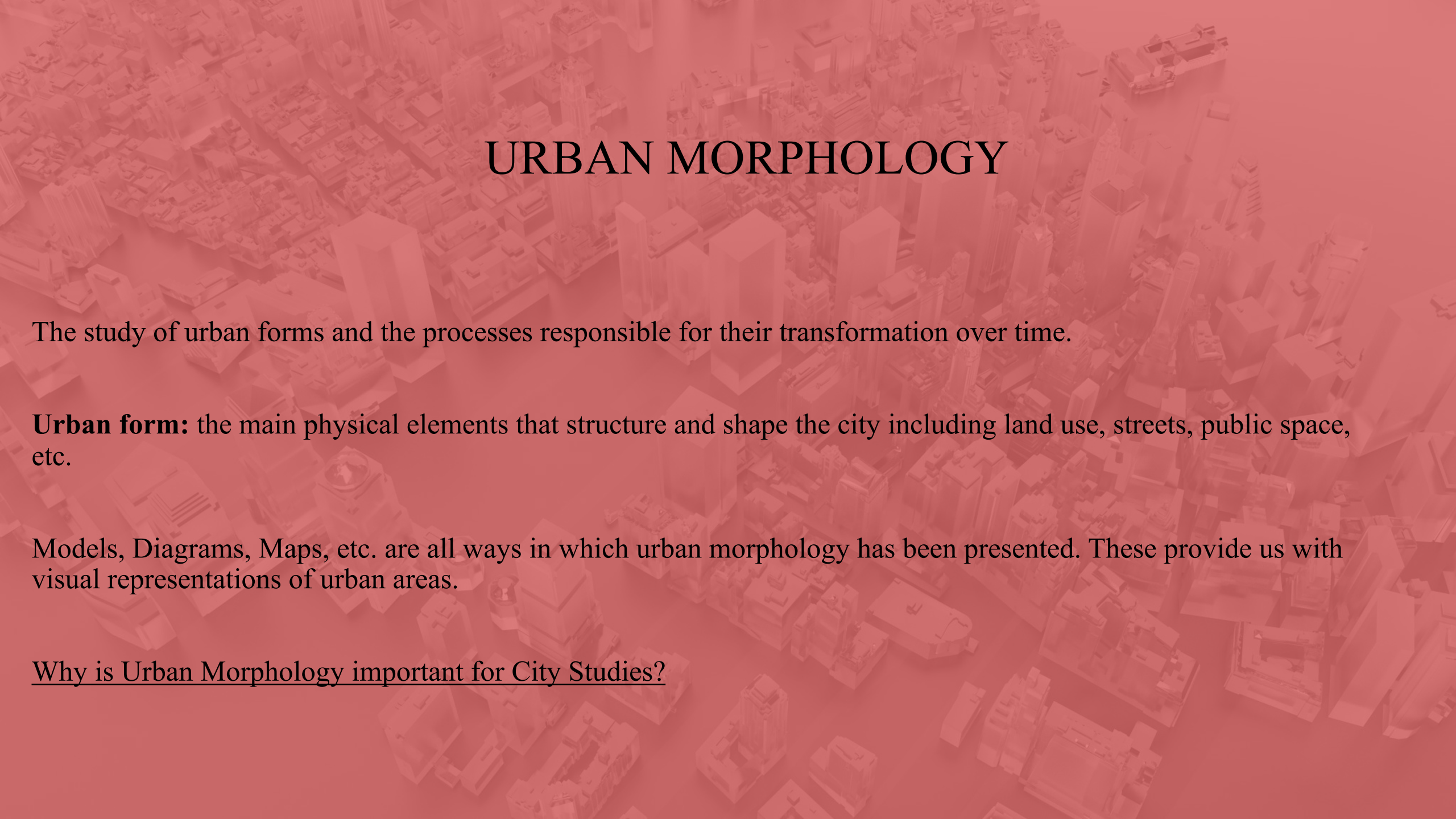
```
selection at the end -add
mirror_ob.select= 1
modifier_ob.select=1
context.scene.objects.active
("Selected" + str(modifier_ob
mirror_ob.select = 0
= bpy.context.selected_object
data.objects[one.name].select
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print("please select exactly
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-- OPERATOR CLASSES ----
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types.Operator):
    X mirror to the selected
object.mirror_mirror_x"
mirror X"
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MODELS OF URBAN GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT

The background of the slide is an aerial photograph of a dense urban area, showing a variety of building heights and street patterns. A semi-transparent red filter is applied over the entire image, creating a monochromatic effect.

URBAN MORPHOLOGY

The study of urban forms and the processes responsible for their transformation over time.

Urban form: the main physical elements that structure and shape the city including land use, streets, public space, etc.

Models, Diagrams, Maps, etc. are all ways in which urban morphology has been presented. These provide us with visual representations of urban areas.

Why is Urban Morphology important for City Studies?

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modifier_ob.select=1
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mirror_ob.select = 0
= bpy.context.selected_objects[0]
data.objects[one.name].select
print("please select exactly one object")

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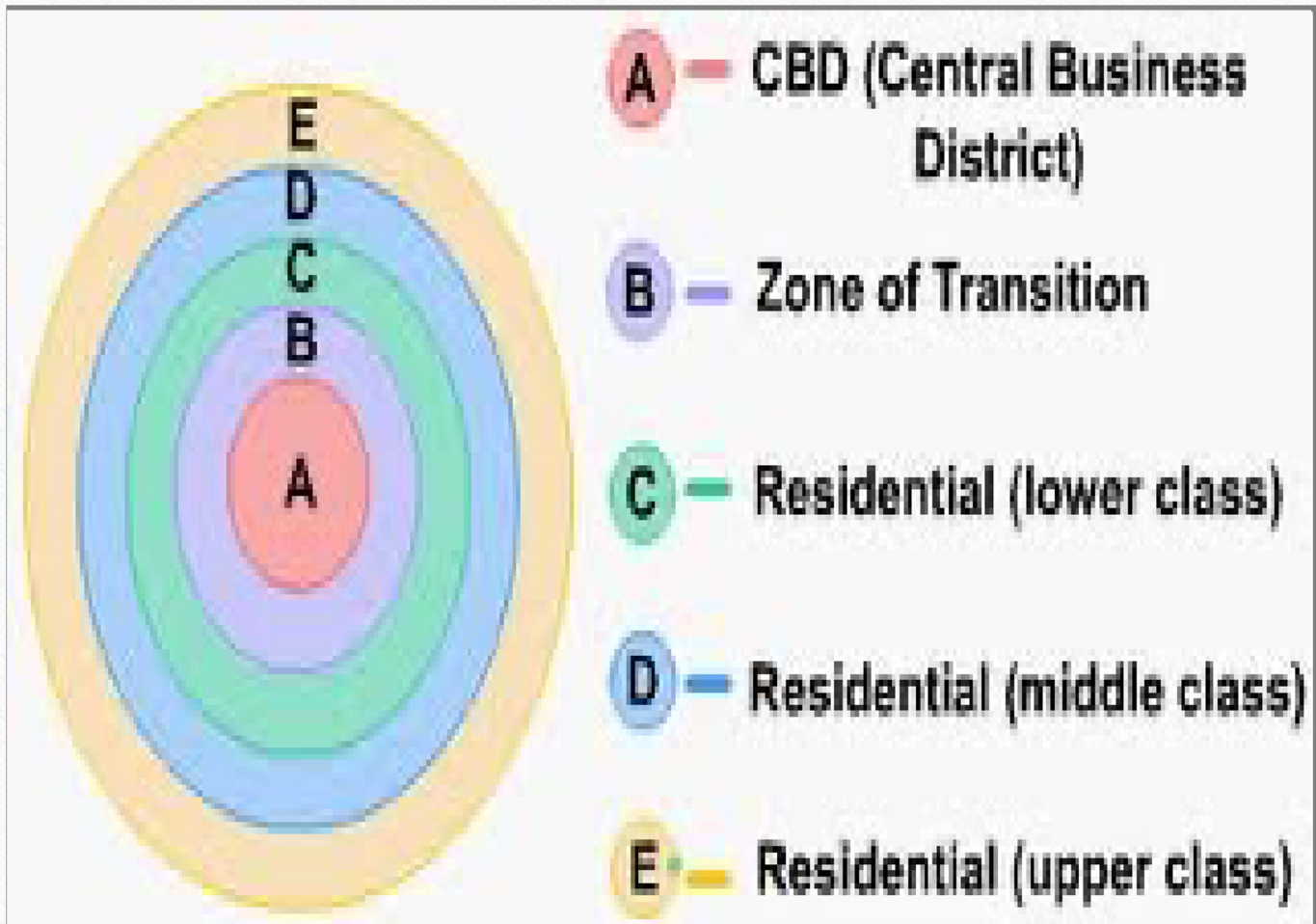
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CHICAGO SCHOOL



CHICAGO SCHOOL

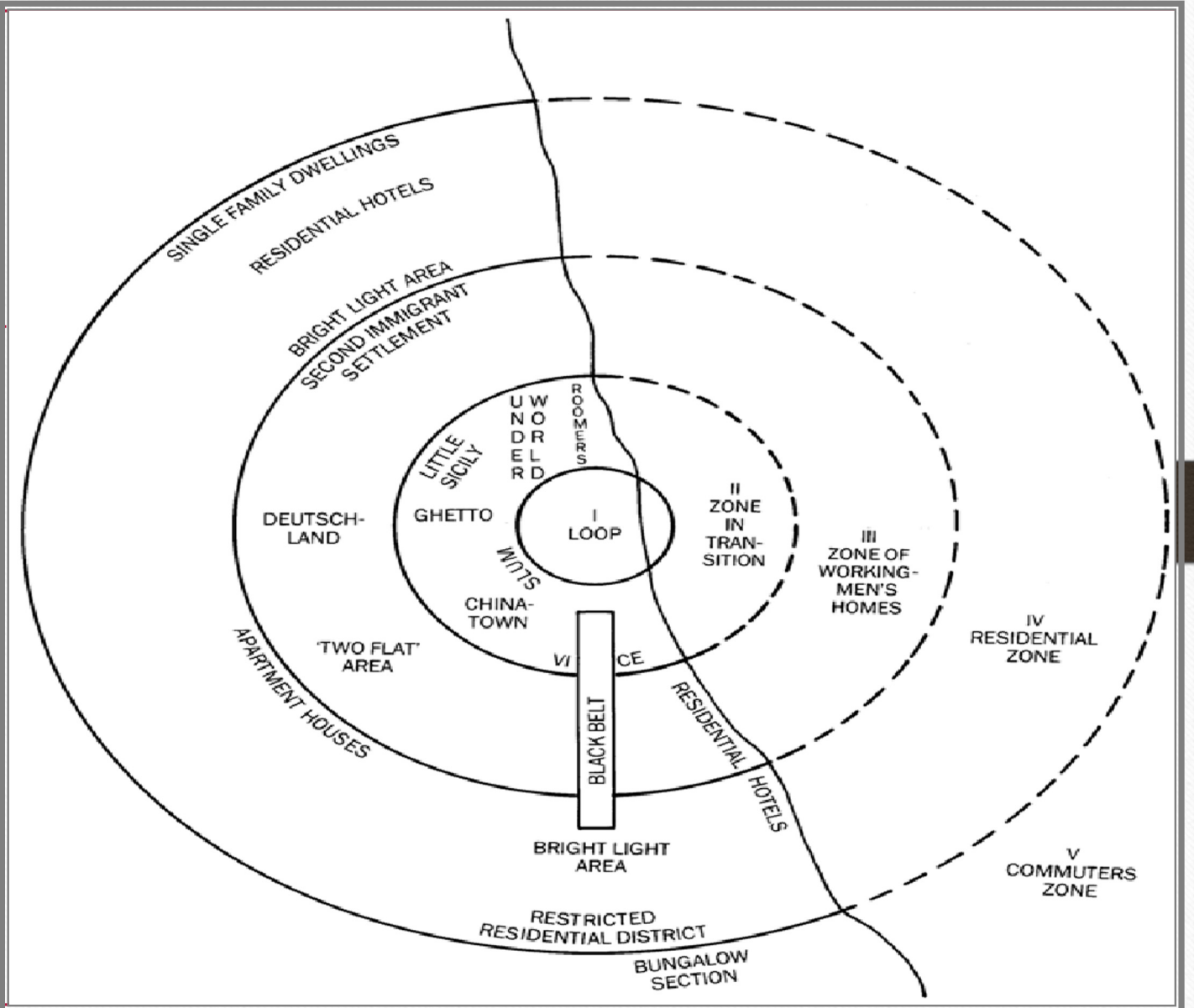
- Ernest Burgess (1925) *The Growth of the City: An Introduction to a Research Project*
- Emerged from the first Sociology Department in the USA, located at the University of Chicago
- From the 1920s to the 1930s scholars from the School established approaches and methodologies for studying urban areas
- The city of Chicago was the focus.



CONCENTRIC RING/ZONE MODEL (BURGESS 1925)

CONCENTRIC RING/ZONE MODEL

- A descriptive model of urban structure to explain land use, urban growth and neighbourhood change
- Urban expansion based on differentiation of land uses and competition among those uses
- Represented the city as a series of 'concentric circles', or zones, with the Central Business District (CBD) at the centre



CONCENTRIC RING/ZONE MODEL

- “represents an ideal construction of the tendencies of any town or city to expand radially from its central business district—on the map “the Loop” (I). Encircling the downtown area there is normally an area in transition, which is being **invaded** by business and light manufacture (II). A third area (III) is inhabited by the workers in industries who have escaped from the area of deterioration (II) but who desire to live within easy access of their work. Beyond this zone is the “residential area” (IV) of high-class apartment buildings or of exclusive “restricted” districts of single-family dwellings. Still farther, out beyond the city limits, is the commuters’ zone: suburban areas, or satellite cities, within a thirty-to sixty-minute ride of the central business district” (Burgess 181)

CONCENTRIC RING/ZONE MODEL

- The process of urban expansion was explained by Burgess in terms of the invasion and succession of one zone into the next outer zone adjacent to it, with physical expansion of the city the result. “the tendency of each inner zone to extend its area by the invasion of the next outer zone” (p.181)
- The mobility assumed in the model to be inherent to urban expansion was seen by Burgess to be both a stimulus to urban growth and the source of instability, especially in lower-income and immigrant communities.
- Thus, crime , poverty , homelessness and social and psychological instability **were seen as naturally occurring phenomena** in the zone of transition just outside of the expanding CBD

CONCENTRIC RING/ZONE MODEL

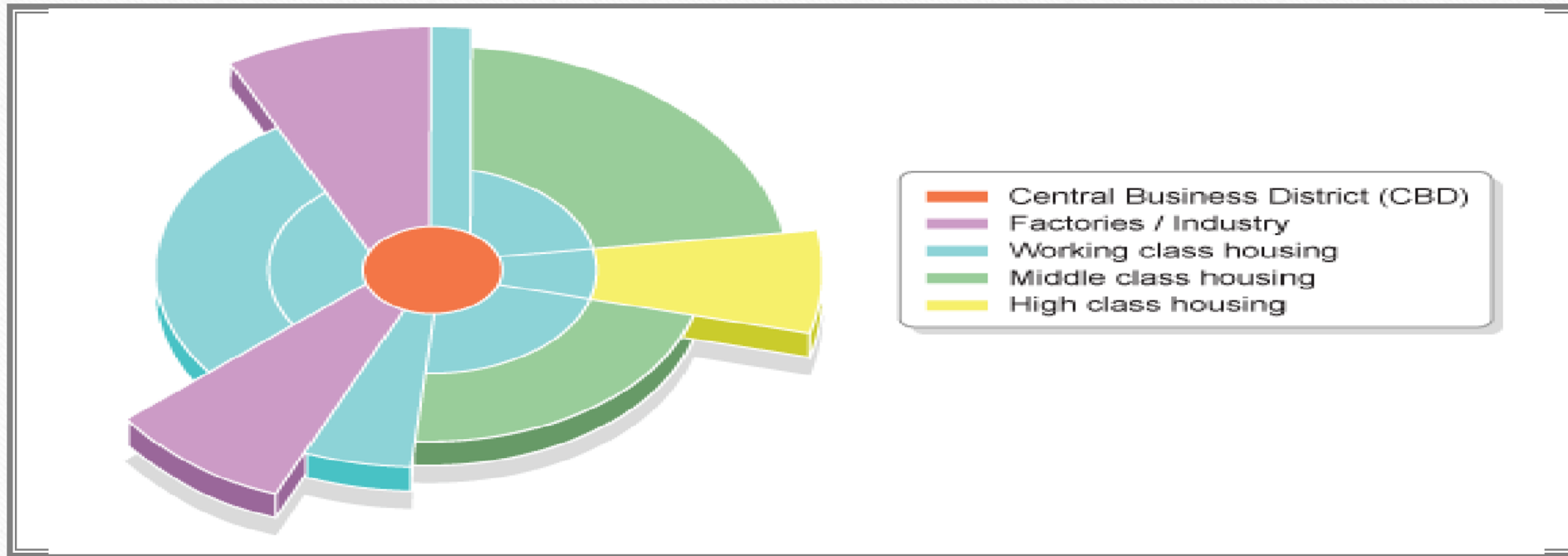
Burgess' model, and the overall goals of the Chicago School to study urban life, community and organization, have been extremely influential in city studies



the assumptions underlying the model and its theory of growth, particularly the naturalization of race, ethnicity and social problems such as crime and homelessness, limits its use and applicability

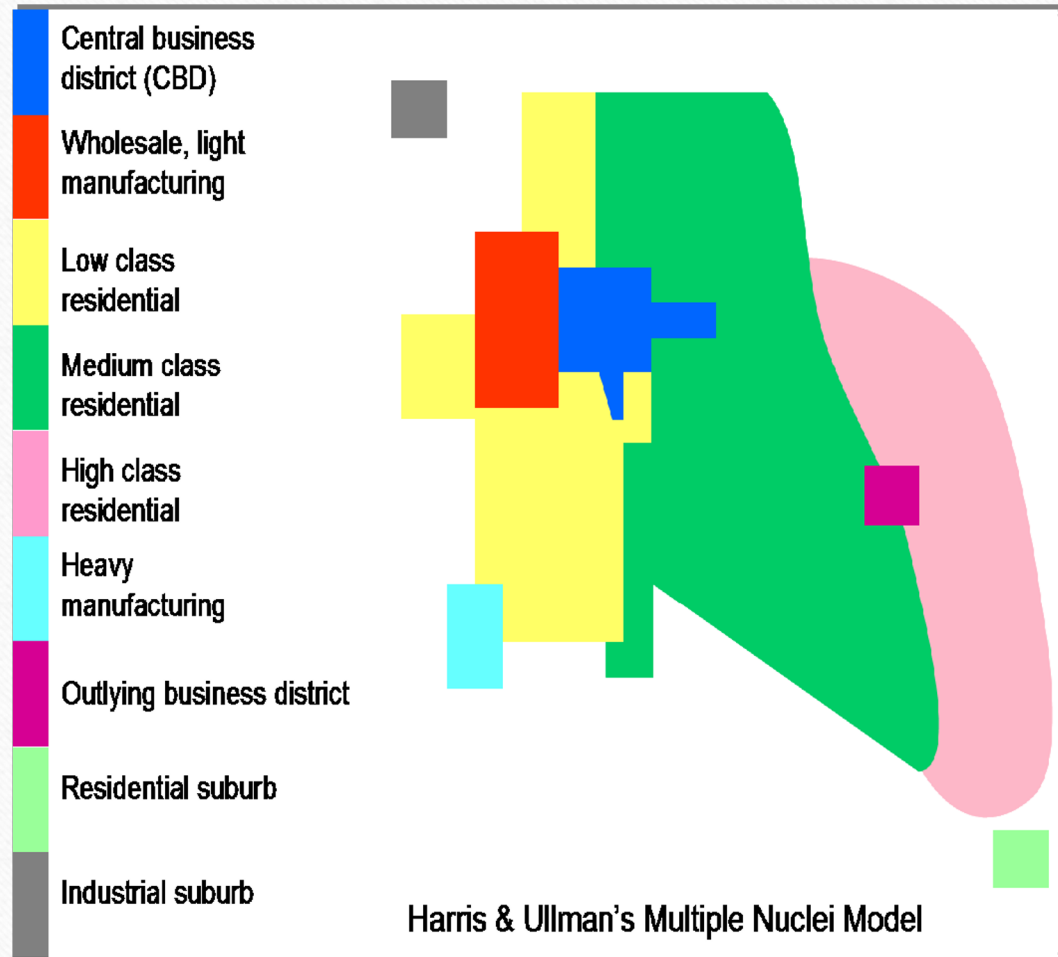
CRITIQUES

- Chicago-centric (and US-centric more broadly)
- Overlooks local politics
- Overlooks global processes
- Does not consider the influence of social and economic processes on urban form (i.e., gentrification)



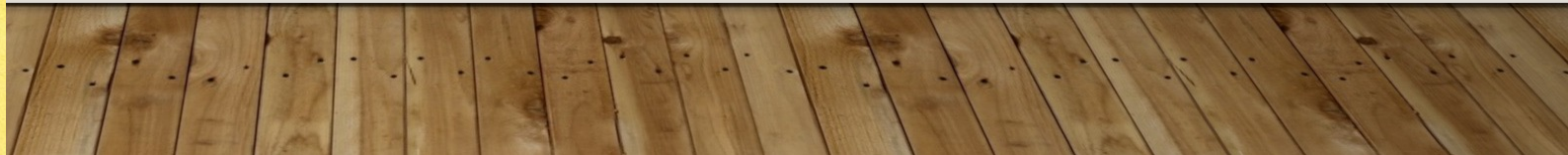
SECTOR MODEL (HOYT 1939)

MULTIPLE NUCLEI MODEL (HARRIS AND ULLMAN 1945)





BREAK - 5 MINUTES




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LOS ANGELES SCHOOL

LA SCHOOL

Refers to a loose collection of urban scholars based in California that emerged in the 1980s and 1990s

Influenced by Marxist theory, examines the impact of global and local economic, political, and social processes on processes of urbanization

Los Angeles as the model of urban morphology and urbanization, not Chicago

LA SCHOOL



Michael Dear argues that Chicago School members, such as Burgess, view city-regions as coherent regional systems in which the central business district (CBD) organizes the rest of city space and the metropolitan hinterland beyond the formal city limits



In contrast, LA school view city-regions as fragmented, with different areas influenced largely by global, rather than purely local, forces

“The imperatives of fragmentation have become the principal dynamic in contemporary cities; the 21st century’s emerging world cities (including LA) are ground-zero loci in a communications-driven globalizing political economy” (Dear 191)



LA SCHOOL

- **World City**: the emergence of a relatively few centers of command and control in a globalizing economy
- **Dual City**: an increasing social polarization, i.e., the increasing gap between rich and poor, between nations, between the powerful and the powerless, between different ethnic, racial, and religious groupings, and between gender

CHICAGO SCHOOL VS LA SCHOOL

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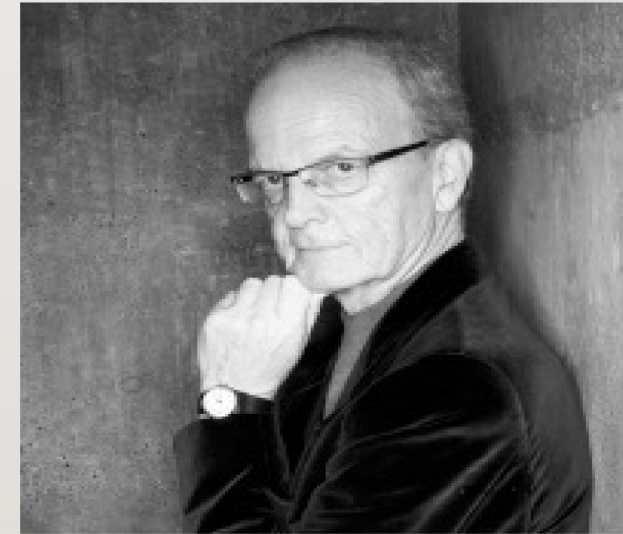
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CHICAGO SCHOOL OF URBAN SOCIOLOGY VS. LOS ANGELES SCHOOL OF URBANISM



Ernest Burgess (1925) *The Growth of the City:
An Introduction to a Research Project*



Michael Dear (2002) *The Los Angeles School of
Urbanism: An Intellectual History*

THE L.A. SCHOOL CRITIQUE OF THE CHICAGO SCHOOL

The **Chicago School** views city regions as coherent regional systems

The **LA School** views city-regions as fragmented

The **Chicago School** emphasizes the importance of the Central Business District (CBD) in structuring the city region

The **LA School** sees different areas shaped by global rather than local forces

THE L.A. SCHOOL CRITIQUE OF THE CHICAGO SCHOOL

Burgess and the **Chicago School** emphasized the importance of personal choice in shaping urban conditions

The **LA School** emphasized global structural forces and corporate-dominated connectivity

Burgess and the **Chicago School** see urban development as linear and teleological

The **LA School** sees it as non-linear and chaotic.



CRITIQUES OF THE LA SCHOOL

- Highlights increased socio-economic polarization, but it overlooks the role of gender in urban inequality
- Los Angeles (or any city) can be seen as a model for processes of urbanization
- Global processes of urbanization do not fit neatly into any model that looks at urban form

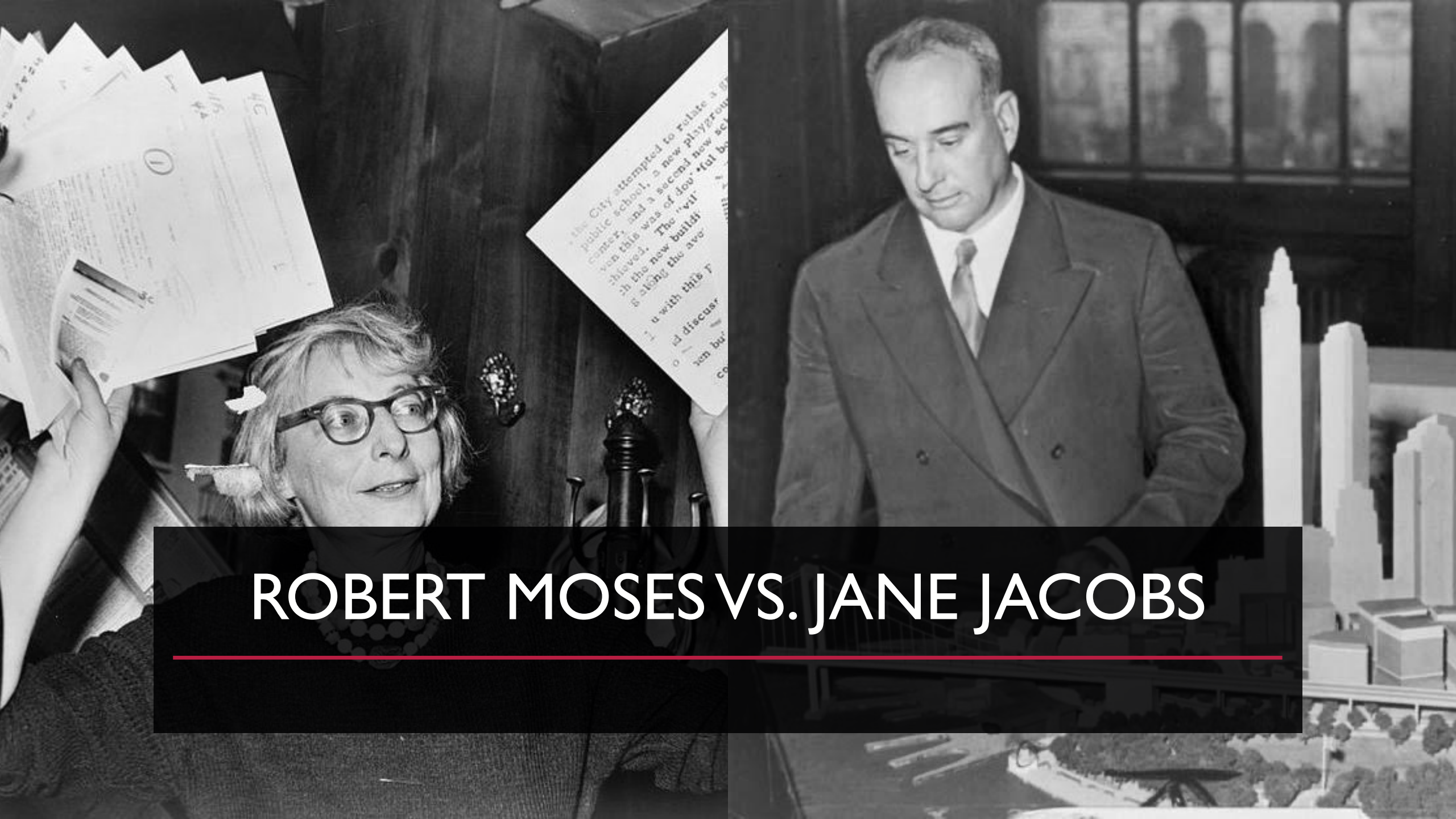
EMERGING URBAN FORMS

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ROBERT MOSES VS. JANE JACOBS

JANE JACOBS VS ROBERT MOSES: URBAN FIGHT OF THE CENTURY



[HTTPS://WWW.YOUTUBE.COM/WATCH?V=AUEUQT6T7KG](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=AUEUQT6T7KG)



WHAT ARE THE KEY POINTS HERE?



HOW DO HIGHWAYS AND
TRANSPORTATION MECHANISMS SHAPE
URBAN FORM?



- Starting in the 1970s, planners began to integrate land uses by promoting mixed use developments;



- Mixed-use strategies reflect the philosophy of Jane Jacobs and the influence of concerns over sustainable development;



- Most mixed-use projects combine residential and commercial uses, and sometimes add civic uses.

MIXED-USE FORMS

MIXED USE COMMUNITIES

01

- Communities that meet people's needs for daily living throughout an entire lifetime;

02

- Access to jobs, services, housing, community infrastructure, open spaces;

03

- Convenient access to public transportation and support for safe, non-motorized travel.

DISCUSSION

- Please check the discussion tab under the materials for this week on the modules page.
- Upload before the end of class - 1pm.
- Please respond in 150 – 250 words.
- **Explain three of the main differences between the Chicago School vs The LA School. Which one do you think is more applicable in YOUR city today, and why?**

Next Steps

Urban Inequality, Social Exclusion and Resistance

- Madanipour, Ali. 2015 [1998]. “Social Exclusion and Space.” Pp. 203-211 in The City Reader.
- Galabuzi, G.-E., Peel. Human Services., & Teelucksingh, C. (2010). Social Cohesion, Social Exclusion, Social Capital. Region of Peel, Human Services. Chapter 2

